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Ed Snook
SBC Planning Office
By email

OBJECTION TO S/OUT/13/1555

Dear Sir,

I object to the application. Irrespective of these objections, additional points are added in this response where the relevant concerns might be partially addressed by means of conditions to any grant of the outline application.

1. Main Street from Keypoint

Summary of Objection

- The route from the new roundabout north of Keypoint is unnecessary and is in conflict with the Local Plan policy RA3 as it travels across open countryside and is not *'within the boundary of the expanded village'.* It also conflicts with RA3 in that, together with the northern access to Rowborough, it will inevitably *'form a bypass for Rowborough traffic'.* A more effective access onto Thornhill Road has been offered by a third party in line with the draft SM Neighbourhood Plan. However, the developers have failed to explore this and how it would provide increased viability as it would avoid the cost incurred in providing the Main Street and the spur road up to the housing parcel south of Thornhill Industrial Estate.

- At its south western end, the route of the Main Street forms a 'super-junction' with its accompanying spur road. This conflicts at this point with the existing private vehicle rights and users of the Bridleway 4 and footpaths which form a major off-road route between South Marston and Gablecross. The developers will destroy valued hedges and not be able to screen the road or the junctions appropriately, in contravention of their Landscape and Visibility Impact Assessment (Appendix 11).

- Furthermore, the route of the Main Street prevents the principle, which was adopted within the SM Neighbourhood Plan and will be reinforced in the draft SBC NEV Masterplan, of a network of cycleways and off-road Rights of Way for horses, cyclists and pedestrians. In particular, it compromises the existing route of Bridleway 4, and the existing footpath 5 extension, planned to be upgraded to an off road cycleway. These require access to reach respectively the medieval sunken lane to Gablecross roundabout and the ramped footbridge over the railway. It is therefore in conflict with Local Plan Policy NC3 which aims to create connectivity for cycle and foot traffic throughout the NEV.

Justification for objection

In deciding the route of The Main Street, the developers have created a 'super junction' in open countryside which crosses the single lane public highway (a medieval sunken lane bounded by mature hedgerows) from Thornhill Road to South Marston Farm at its junction with Bridleway 4. This junction will need to accommodate:

- Maintenance of private vehicle rights of way from Bridleway no 4 (two dwellings)
- Maintenance of road access from the three dwellings at South Marston Farm
- Safe route for pedestrians and horses using the bridleway and the sunken lane.

Two separate junctions are required at this point because a spur road is required to travel north across what will be public access green infrastructure to reach the housing development south of Thornhill Industrial Estate.

The design:

- Creates a dangerous set of junctions, which will need to be lit, despite being in open countryside
- Fails to ensure safety of existing users on horse, foot and cycle and brings conflict between car traffic, and users on foot, horse and cycle.
- Bisects two different areas of green infrastructure which are supposed to be for public enjoyment, reducing their benefit
- Impedes the delivery of the proposed cycle network in the draft Neighbourhood Plan and the draft SBC New Eastern Villages Masterplan, in that one of the critical off-road cycle routes for South Marston (and Rowborough) traffic to reach Gablecross roundabout will also end up at this super-junction. Of particular concern is the conflict between horses and vehicles at this point.

  27.21. …….. The existing Bridleway 4 is valued as an alternative route on foot/bike/horse out of the village, linking as it does to the sunken lane that joins Thornhill Road north of Keypoint roundabout. The sunken lane is also of some historic cultural interest. The original 'entrance' to Manor Farmhouse is via the sunken lane, bearing left through a double hedge and then north along the existing footpath 5. This is the preferred route for the Cycleway A link to Keypoint roundabout as described in Section 19 of this plan. (draft SM Neighbourhood Plan).

- Cannot realistically provide adequate screening from what will be areas of significant public use (public green infrastructure, Footpath 5, Bridleway no 4) which is contrary to the developer's own assessment of the impact of development. The appropriate references for hedgerow removal are hedge H9(c) and H17(c) in Appendix A12e. The following quotes from Appendix 11 in the application documents in are relevant:

  8. The availability of open and clear views into the Site is largely confined to close range views from localised viewpoints. This includes residents on the edge of South Marston, Old Vicarage Lane and users of rights of way. The relatively flat landform character of the Site and <u>the network of overlapping hedgerows and mature trees tend to restrict the extent of visibility across the Site for these local receptors</u>. (Appendix 11 Addendum p7)

  12. There is also intervisibility between the Site and local properties and farms that lie in close proximity such as Rowborough Farm, <u>South Marston Farm and Manor Farm</u>. The intervening network of hedgelines and trees provides some filtering of views across the Site from these receptors. (Appendix 11 Addendum p7)

  *8.3.5 The proposed Green Infrastructure framework (GIF) provision as shown on the revised Development Framework Plan **(Appendix 3** to the ES Further Information Report**)** has been developed to avoid, reduce and offset any significant adverse effects arising from the Proposed Development. At the same time, the GIF seeks to provide compensatory landscape features, as well as delivering long term landscape and recreational benefits, in addition to ecological enhancement. (LVIA Addendum p8).*

  Unfortunately, the design of the super-junction removes significant sections of the hedgerows at this point, and there is no room for reinstatement and no room for adequate screening of the new

road or the junction lighting.

To reinforce the need to respect the ancient nature of the sunken lane and its continuation to South Marston Farm, the following photographs are relevant: The first shows the secluded nature of the sunken lane, the second is a pre-1900 map identifying that this lane and its continuation to meet Footpath 5 were the original access route to Manor Farmhouse, the most prominent historical residence in South Marston. The route was bounded either side by hedgerows which are still in existence (see extract from draft SM Neighbourhood Plan below).

Sunken Lane

Proposed Super Junction

Ftpath 5

Should the access from the Main Street at Keypoint be approved, it is requested that adjustments of the route and its junction with the spur road are sought, to alleviate the above concerns.

2. Road Access from Rowborough

I object to the construction of two roads to connect Rowborough with Old Vicarage Lane which conflicts with the Local Plan Policy RA3 that requires that the 'Main Street' does not *form a bypass for Rowborough traffic* to reach Gablecross.

If this application is granted, then it is appropriate that a condition requiring that the primary access for Rowborough traffic under the railway to the east of the development site is constructed before more than 500 houses have been built. Otherwise, there will not be adequate connectivity across the A420 and no safe route for Rowborough cyclists and pedestrians to reach the southern NEV and, in particular, the secondary school.

3. Road Link north of Manor Farm

Condition required, should the application be granted: Arrangements for breaching Bridleway 4 must be pursued prior to any detailed development proposals being submitted.

The road link north of Manor Farm, via the village centre and southward across the bridleway must be constructed; it is essential to comply with Policy RA3 to support the integration of the expanded village and the reduction of traffic at Pound Corner. The developers have conceded that this is deliverable, via the use of s237 measures, and SBC has agreed to this proposal. However, the link road is shown only on the illustrative plan, rather than confirmed directly by this outline application. If this road is not constructed, the existing bridleway will inevitably be used as a vehicle access in contravention of private vehicle rights of way since no roads would provide an alternative north-south route from the centre of the expanded village.

4. Road links to other strategic development parcels must be enabled

Condition required, should the application be granted: to provide connectivity and reduce traffic on existing village roads (Policies NC3 and RA3), road accesses must be enabled with neighbouring strategic NEV land and/or land subject to future housing development. No detailed applications should be pursued that do not enable such road links.

The development parcel south of Thornhill Industrial Estate must enable road links westward into Oxleaze Farm and northward into Thornhill Road Industrial Estate as shown on the illustrative map. It should also allow connection with Manor Farmyard, which is not shown on the illustrative map. This site has already been the subject of permitted development applications, and would be otherwise quarantined from orderly development because of the poor road access along Bridleway 4.

5. Flood Risk

Condition required, should the application be granted. A revised SUDs strategy should be required as a reserved matter on any outline permission. It is not acceptable that this is left to any detailed planning application.

The developer's assessment of flood risk is inadequate. It correctly identifies fluvial flooding and the need for a drainage channel extending from the rear of Manor Park, diagonally towards Red House and eventually reaching the proposed basin west of the Carpenters Arms. However, it fails to address the need to retain surface water flooding onsite where sites, including existing dwellings, are enclosed within the development area.

In particular, the development area behind Thornhill Industrial Estate, including the road access to the south, means that there are off- site areas that are vulnerable to increased surface water run-off at Manor Farmhouse, Manor Farmyard, Southview Cottages and the Bridleway itself. Local residents on Manor Farm have long experience of the degree of flooding affecting the central area of the farm and wish to see their land safeguarded against increased run off as a result of development.

The flow of surface water flooding eastward across the development site will be cut by the construction of the Main Street in many places, <u>so an acceptable SUDs strategy needs to be submitted prior to any road construction being started.</u>

Whereas it would be possible to accommodate appropriate SUDs measures in this area, I would ask that a revised SUDs strategy is submitted that addresses the above concerns and that this forms a reserved matter associated with the grant of outline permission.

6. Green Infrastructure

Condition required, should the application be granted. A reserved matter on a grant of outline permission relating to landscaping should specifically note that the visibility of the development from public viewpoints of roads and lighting in open countryside must be addressed.

The report on green infrastructure, in particular the Landscape and Visibility Assessment Survey (Appendix 11) demonstrates the impact of visibility of roads and housing from public viewpoints. Significant screening will be required in general, and in particular where it the viewpoints are in open countryside or future green infrastructure. It should also protect from undue visual intrusion existing properties, such as Southview Cottages on Manor Farm, that lie adjacent to the development areas.

7. Utilities

Whereas all utilities are likely to be subject to significant upgrade, I request that you bear in mind:

- Local Plan Policy RA3 which states that development must '*realise opportunities to facilitate main drainage and utilities supply to existing properties that currently lack connections where possible'*.
- Neighbourhood Plan POLICY 12 - UTILITIES '*Development proposals for individual parcels of land*

shall be accompanied by an assessment of potential for utilities connection to existing dwellings that lie within the development parcel or adjacent to it, where no connection currently exists to mains drainage or where current utility connection will be affected. Prior to the grant of reserved matters approval(s), applicants will be required, where practical, to offer to facilitate such connections at reasonable cost'.

- Note that the water supply to existing houses will be cut in several places as soon as construction of the Main Street begins.

Dwellings and businesses on Manor Farm will be surrounded by proposed development sites. Existing supply to these dwellings of power, water and telephony lie over or under the development sites and the developers have made no effort to contact residents to guarantee continuation. None of the dwellings have mains sewerage or gas supply and connection to these properties would be in the interests of not just existing residents, but those who come to live in the vicinity. <u>It would be appropriate for these residents to have some contact with either the Borough Council or the developers to ascertain how and when the above policies will be addressed</u>

8. Construction

It is inevitable that, should permission be granted, that the new Main Street becomes the construction access road. If the construction process is to proceed following grant of outline permission, appropriate conditions will be required to alleviate nuisance and noise. Conditions on noise and allowable hours of work will be important. In particular, the line of the road is constructed over the existing water supply to Manor Farm – arrangements for safeguarding this will be necessary.

9. Education

I do not believe the alternative plan for 2 small schools at South Marston would be viable and wish every effort to be made to explore an expanded school option before the developers are allowed to pursue such a proposal.